

THE CLIMAX



HAMPSHIRE COLLEGE

VOLUME VI

Unionization policy sparks debate

By STEVEN WHITE
Staff Writer

THERE'S NO DOUBT in my mind that unions have been extraordinarily important champions for workers, and actually I think for a better society," said President Ralph Hexter. He further said, "It's unfortunate when you see currently" the gains made by workers "rendered meaningless" as the influence of unions continues to decline in America. This, no doubt, is common ground for the President and Students for the Freedom to Unionize (SFU), a student group that has been pressing him on union issues. But beyond this, significant disagreements emerge.

SFU claims Hampshire College has an "unacknowledged legacy of union-busting." Physical Plant staff tried unsuccessfully to unionize with the United Electrical, Radio and Machine Workers of America (UE) in 1994-95. "Fact sheets" were

fort to unionize the entire staff of Hampshire College with the Service Employees International Union (SEIU). It also failed. Documents from this time period make it seem clear the administration of the College actively opposed this organizing effort as well. Papers provided by SFU claim that many members of the Board of Trustees are against unions. During the 1990s, SFU also notes that Hampshire hired the Skoler, Abbott, and Presser law firm in Springfield, which they say is known for union-busting.

One issue of disagreement between SFU and President Hexter is "union neutrality," which refers to the administration remaining neutral to the question of unionization. While the President said he is "totally neutral on unions," he and SFU offer different understandings of what this means in specific scenarios. For SFU, this means that the President



Lainee Broad Ginsberg conducts students in a rehearsal which will be held on Wednesday, December 6 at 7:30PM

Re-Rad creates new D

By JOHN KENNEDY
Staff Writer

SHORTLY BEFORE Thanksgiving break, The Re-Radicaliza-

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and administrators sa

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